

# BEYOND THE IIMS

They are fast catching up with the big boys. These schools, featured prominently in the BT-AC Nielsen Best B-school survey, offer a desirable combination of both facilities and intellectual capital. Having wowed all stakeholders, from recruiters to aspiring students, these are the B-schools to watch out for. Find out what makes them tick.



**T**his institute has neither the halo attached to the IIMS, nor the legendary guest lecturers from the corporate world that other institutes boast of. Yet, the Symbiosis Institute of Business Management (SIBM), located in a non-residential campus in Pune that can only be described as modest, ranks as the fourth best B-school in the country, ahead of three IIMS. SIBM is the most reputed of the six management institutes that the Symbiosis society runs.

What is it that gives the institute a place in the coveted top 10? Director Arun Muddbidri believes that besides being equipped with one of the best management faculties in the country, the other two factors that make SIBM a

good institute are its accomplished alumni and extensive corporate interaction. Not only this. The institute takes in only 180 students of the one lakh students who take the SNAP (Symbiosis National Aptitude Programme) test.

Under the Young Managers Development Programme the institute provides guidance to students during the first six months of their professional life, helping them sail through the obstacles that beginners usually confront. Corporate interaction is the second pillar of strength at SIBM. This interaction is two-way—with the institute providing high-quality research papers to corporates who, in turn, facilitate projects and training opportunities for students.